

Damian Zaremba

I am a passionate RYA Yachtmaster Instructor (sail) with a track record of delivering high-quality training.

Having worked within the same sailing area for a couple of years, I am seeking new opportunities that allow me to keep my skills fresh and experience new challenges.

I am a qualified diving instructor and first aid instructor trainer, with a professional background in IT.

Nationality: British | Permanent Resident: The Netherlands | Languages: English (Native), Netherlands (Beginner)

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Background

I started sailing dinghy's from 2004 until 2009, after moving to the Netherlands in 2016 I started sailing on yachts.

In 2021 I decided to have a priority-change and purchased my own yacht, taking a break from IT.

While working as a diving instructor, I decided to use my transferable teaching skills and become a cruising instructor.

After an enjoyable season and being more involved in the RTC, I had a very enjoyable week in the solent and was rewarded with a yachtmaster instructor ticket.

Within the RTC I have worked to streamline processes, ensuring visibility into key areas such as expiry dates and defects, with very positive feedback from the center inspector.

Outside of teaching, I have also provided support during yacht maintenance, including electrical/electronic troubleshooting/modification, GRP/gel coat repairs and rigging checks/replacement.

Certificates

- Yachtmaster Instructor for Sail (valid until 2028)
- Commercially endorsed PB2 & Yachtmaster Offshore
- STCW personal survival/basic first aid
- ENG1
- Food hygiene level 2, Safe and Fun
- RYA diesel engine, RADAR, DS/YM/Ocean shorebased

Experience summary

- Sailed ~14k nm since 2017
- Single-handed ~6k nm with 3 ocean crossings since 2021
- ~1700 nm (13 weeks) teaching as a CI
- ~4500 nm (42 weeks) teaching as a YMI
- > 300 days sea going service - testimonial available
- > 100 certificates issued (~75% CC/DS, ~25% CS)
- > 20 YM exam candidates prepped (~95% pass rate)

Maritime work experience

Senior Yachtmaster Instructor

Canary Sail SL

April 2024 - April 2025

- 1/3 YMIs allowed to do exam preparations
- Only YMI actively doing preps outside the CI

Freelance Skipper

Various

August 2022 - Present

- RIB operations (primarily scuba diving)
- Boat delivery/relocation & maintenance

Yachtmaster Instructor

Canary Sail SL

April 2023 - April 2024

- 60% conducting CS courses or skills weeks
- 40% doing exam pre-preparation

Cruising Instructor

Canary Sail SL

December 2022 - April 2023

- CC/DS courses
- Mile building / skill weeks

Other work experience

- IT Consultant (various)
- Diving Instructor (various)
- First Aid Instructor/Trainer (various)
- Senior Network Engineer (Fastly)
- Network Engineer (Booking.com)
- Principal Security Engineer (Rentalcars.com)
- Technical Architect (Rentalcars.com)

Various technology positions held since 2008

Future plans

I'm looking to continue my own growth and value long term relationships built on trust and respect.

My approach is detail oriented and safety conscious.

I champion quality of delivery and avoiding dilution of credentials.

Additional qualifications I am open to / planning to obtain:

- RYA Shorebased / SRC / RADAR instructor
- Master 200gt (coded vessels) / OOW 500 (yacht)
- Powerboat Instructor (possibly RYA YM/CI Motor)